

Chapter 128-2

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Liang Shi bought a crucian carp. The wet market was more chaotic compared to the supermarket.

She used to come here often and knew this place like the back of her hand.

After buying the fish and side ingredients, she also called Sister Wang and Xiao Bai to come to her place for lunch.

She carried her things back again.

She still took the same route from this morning.

The newly opened flower shop was the most eye-catching store on this street. The flower shop was called "Deep Sea Sleepless,"¹ carrying an artistic air.

On her way back, Liang Shi passed by the flower shop and subconsciously glanced inside.

She didn't see Qi Jiao again.

The flowers at the shop's entrance were arranged with unique creativity, and a wooden sign reading "Welcome" hung at the door.

Not seeing Qi Jiao again, Liang Shi felt somewhat disappointed.

When she returned to the entrance of her residential complex carrying her groceries, a man wearing a baseball cap and a black hoodie brushed past her.

He had a cold and aloof aura and was quite good-looking, so Liang Shi took an extra look.

Then she noticed he walked into that flower shop.

Liang Shi went home full of curiosity.

Her curiosity would go unanswered. In the past, she had Xu Qingzhu to help her work through the logic. A top student's brain was always useful—she could easily sort out clues without Liang Shi having to think much at all.

But now she could only think by herself.

Qi Jiao would hand her White Rabbit milk candies just like when she was little. She would tell her that life would definitely get better. When she smiled, her eyes would sparkle like they were mixed with crushed diamonds, and even the curve of her eyes when she smiled was the same as when she was little.

It was hard to say she wasn't the Qi Jiao from another world.

But how did she get here?

Based on her previous experience, did dying cause one to switch back and forth between the two worlds?

Then if she went and died now, could she go back?

This was an unknown.

There weren't enough reference points to prove the success rate and rationality of this matter.

Liang Shi thought while preparing the fish.

Meanwhile, in the flower shop outside the residential complex, Qi Jiao was trimming flower stems. The man wearing the baseball cap with the cold and aloof aura pushed open the door and came in. Qi Jiao stood up to greet him: "Welcome..."

Before she could finish speaking, she saw who it was and swallowed the rest of her words.

Qi Jiao broke into an even brighter smile. "Gē!² You're back."

"Mm." Qi Jun took off his baseball cap, hooking up a roguish smile. "If I hadn't heard it from Mom, I wouldn't have known you'd made something of yourself."

Qi Jiao: "..."

She pouted. "Well, I need to have something to do."

Qi Jun shrugged. "You could go to your sister's company. There's always a suitable position. Who knew you wanted to be a boss so badly."

"I'm so stupid. If I went, people would say I got in through the back door."³ Qi Jiao sat back down in her original spot and continued trimming flower stems. "I'd rather not cause trouble for you all. Opening a flower shop is so nice. Seeing people's happy expressions when they hold flowers makes me happy."

"As long as you're happy." Qi Jun smiled indulgently. "When the time comes, I'll have them all come buy flowers."

"No, no." Qi Jiao said, "Just let my shop remain a hidden gem in the city."⁴ Your fans and buddies have too much purchasing power. If they buy out my flower shop, I'll be exhausted to death."

Qi Jun was stunned for a moment. "That's true."

Afterward, Qi Jun asked if she had eaten breakfast.

Qi Jiao nodded. "I already ate. Did you forget? I need to take medicine in the morning."

"How much longer do you need to take that medicine?" Qi Jun asked. "Does it work?"

"I don't know either. They say it can improve memory, but I had my sister look at it before, and she said it's targeted at middle-aged and elderly people. But since Mom already bought it, I'll just take it." Qi Jiao smiled. "My fish-like brain probably can't be fixed anyway."

"Then stop taking it." Qi Jun said, "Mom always buys you these strange things, and you're the only one who listens to her and does everything she says."

Qi Jiao shrugged indifferently. "Well, I'm so stupid, and Mom is just looking out for me."

Qi Jun sighed helplessly. "You're too obedient."

"Everyone should have at least one good quality." Qi Jiao arranged the trimmed flower stems together, the colors beautifully coordinated. "My only remaining good quality is probably being obedient."

Qi Jun: "..."

While wrapping flowers, Qi Jiao said, "Gē, do you know Chen Mian?"

Qi Jun's hand paused while playing with his phone. He looked up and frowned. "What's wrong?"

"Nothing, I just met someone today." Qi Jiao said, "She mentioned this name, and I felt it sounded very familiar, but I still can't remember."

Including the flower shop's name "Deep Sea Sleepless"—that was also something she had thought of in a flash of inspiration.

At that time, she didn't know why, but she suddenly thought of this very artistic name.

Qi Jun thought for a moment. "I don't know. Never heard of it."

"It sounds like a very artistic name." Qi Jiao's hands were very skilled; she could easily wrap a beautiful bouquet. "I always feel like I've seen this person before, but I can't remember. This goldfish brain of mine."

"Then just don't remember." Qi Jun said, "You just need to remember us, and that's enough."

Qi Jiao nodded. "That's true."

But she always felt that Chen Mian was a very important person.

1. Deep Sea Sleepless (深海未眠, Shēnhǎi Wèimián): The shop name contains "眠" (mián), which means "sleep" and is also part of Chen Mian's name (陳眠). This is a subconscious connection Qi Jiao made without realizing it. ⇐
2. Gē (哥): A Chinese term meaning "older brother." It's commonly used as an affectionate address for an older male sibling or close male friend who is older. ⇐
3. Got in through the back door (走後門): A Chinese idiom meaning to use personal connections or nepotism to gain advantages, bypassing proper procedures or merit-based selection. ⇐
4. Hidden gem in the city (大隱隱於市): A Chinese idiom meaning "a great hermit hides in the city." It refers to someone or something that remains unassuming and hidden despite being in a bustling urban environment, choosing obscurity over fame. ⇐